Important State News and Events of 2025

Abhijit Appointed Chef de Mission

The Assam Olympic Association (AOA) has appointed Abhijit Bhattacharya, former captain of the Indian National Volleyball Team, as the Chef de Mission for the Assam contingent at the 38th National Games, 2025. The event is scheduled to take place in Uttarakhand.

Elephant Population Increased in Assam

The Elephant Population Estimation – 2024 report released in January-2025 has recorded 5,828 elephants in Assam, an increase from 5,719 in 2017. The Chirang – Ripu Elephant Reserve recorded the highest density of 79 elephants per 100 sq km.

Veteran Actress Gyanada Kakati Passed Away

Veteran actress, singer and radio announcer Gyanada Kakati breathed her last at Bethany Hospital in Shillong in January-2025. Born in Shillong of undivided Assam, Kakati started her career through the film *Parghat* in 1948. Later, she became popular for her performance in the 1959 film *Puberun*.

Besides *Parghat* and *Puberun*, she has a number of Assamese films to her credit. These include *Piyali Phukan, Sarapat, Lakhimi, Ronga Police, Puwoti Nisar Sopon, Saknoiya, Narakasur, Sesh Bisar, Opor Mahala, Pratham Ragini, Priyajan* and *Rag-Birag*. Five of the films she has acted also won national awards.

She was not only the first Assamese actress but also one of the first Indian actresses to have received international recognition and fame. Her film *Puberun* directed by ace film-maker Prabhat Mukherjee was selected to be screened at the Berlin International Film Festival where she was invited as a special guest. *Puberun* was the only film to represent India at the Berlin International Film Festival in the year 1960 alongside films like *Breathless* of France's Jean-Luc Godard. Gyanada Kakati was the first Assamese actress to receive the President's Silver Medal from late Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan in recognition for her work in *Puberun*.

Assamese Department in Santiniketan

The University Grants Commission (UGC) has approved the proposal of Visva-Bharati, Santiniketan to upgrade its Assamese department to a full-fledged department with more teaching faculty.

The department of Assamese at Visva-Bharati, Santiniketan was commenced in 1979 with one assistant professor. It is the first and only department of Assamese in India outside Assam.

Assam a Must-visited Place in 2025, by *The New York Times*

The New York Times, one of the world's most widely read English newspapers, has listed Assam among its '52 Places to Travel in 2025'. The publication highlighted Kaziranga National Park, Kamakhya Temple and the Charaideo Moidams as must-visit destinations in the State.

Singpho King Bisa Nong Singpho Passed Away

Singpho King Bisa Nong Singpho, a well-known name in the North-eastern region of the country, passed away in January-2025. Bisa Nang Singpho was famous for making significant contributions to the Singpho society as well as to social life. His death has cast a pall of gloom among his followers in Assam and the neighbouring State of Arunachal Pradesh.

Mohan Bhaira Award to Folk Singer Bijay Medhi

The Mohan Bhaira Memorial Award for 2025 was presented to Bijay Medhi, a prominent folk artiste from Alliya Narayan Gaon in Nalbari district. The

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award is being given by the Nalbari district unit of AASU and Nalbari Zilla Unnati Sabha since 2009.

GI Tag Certificate to Asharikandi Terracotta Officially Presented

The Geographical Indication (GI) tag certificate for the Asharikandi style of terracotta from Dhubri districts was officially handed over at a ceremony in January, 2025. The GI registration, under the Geographical Indication Registry, Government of India, recognised the unique Asharikandi terracotta craft, which falls under Class 21 with GI number 980 and Certificate number 619 in favour of Asharikandi terracotta Doll Making Samabay Samiti Ltd.

Book by Former Police Officer

A book titled A policeman in the Mirror of Time, written by former Additional Director General of Assam Police Phatikdutta Goswami was nationally released at New Delhi in January, 2025. The book was formally released by Gajendra Chauhan, a well-known actor and the former chairman of the Film and Television Institute of India, Pune.

New APSC Chairman

Retired IPS officer Deboraj Upadhaya has been appointed as chairman of the Assam Public Service Commission (APSC) in January-2025. Upadhaya was serving as member of the commission after superannuation.

New Advisor for Agriculture Sector, NE India

The MSME Promotion Council India has announced the appointed of Mowsam Hazarika as advisor for the Agriculture Sector, North East India. His three-year term, effective from 18th January, 2025.

Mizoram Became First NE State to Distribute Property Card

In January, 2025 Mizoram was the first State in the northeast region to distribute property cards under the SVAMITVA (Survey of Villages Abadi and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas) scheme. The Governor virtually participated in the distribution event of Property Cards under the SVAMITVA scheme from the Raj Bhavan in Aizawl.

Noted Musician Abir Borgohain Passed Away

Noted musician, tablaist and a photographer, Abir Borgohain of Jorhat breathed his last on 18th January, 2025. A tabla *bishrad* from Bhatkhande Sangeet Vidyapeeth, Lucknow, Borgohain was associated with several music and dance schools and cultural organization.

State Cabinet Approved Assam Startup and Innovation Policy 2025

To ensure all-round development of Assam as an industrial and investment-friendly State, the Cabinet today approved the Assam Startup and Innovation Policy 2025, Assam Aerospace and Defence Manufacturing Policy 2025 and Assam Action Plan on BioE3 Policy.

The State Cabinet also approved a proposal to extend the benefit of the enhanced loan threshold limit of ₹30 lakh to existing 37,277 beneficiaries with an interest subvention of 1%.

Rowmari-Donduwa Emerged as Potential Ramsar Site

With over 47,000 birds counted during 2025 estimation, the Rowmari-Dondua complex of Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary has emerged as a potential Ramsar Site.

During the 6th Kaziranga Waterbird Count, around 20,653 waterbirds of 75 species were spotted at the Rowmari Beel while 26,480 birds of 88 species were counted in the Donduwa Beel. The counts were higher than that of the Deepor Beel - the only Ramsar site in Assam.

Assam Rabies Elimination Project Launched

Mission Rabies, WVS, in collaboration with JBF (Just Be Friendly) and with the support of the Department of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary, Assam and the Guwahati Municipal Corporation (GMC), officially launched the 'Assam Rabies Elimination Project' in February, 2025.

The Assam Rabies Control Project has been structured into two key segments-one focused on Guwahati's metropolitan area and the other on three model districts of Assam.

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Tengai Mohon Award Conferred on Dr. Atul Borgohain

Writer and medical practitioner and a sports enthusiast, Dr. Atul Borgohain was conferred the Pandit Tengai Mohon Award-2025.

The award function was organised in memory of State's first Assamese lexicographer Tengai Mohon. Tengai Mohon, who had hand-written the Tai Ahom-Assamese dictionary belonged to the Ahom priestly clan. He was instrumental in bringing out the first bilingual lexicon in 1795. Tengai Mohon is also accredited for his books like *Lanphat, Lai Phai, Thankhong, Taptang, Baghdai, Lanmati, Duri, Thabi, Bansang, Khenlung, Kathi Bansang, Alongphura* etc.

Sonowal Dedicated IWT at Jogighopa to Nation

The Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal inaugurated the Inland Waterways Terminal (IWT) on river Brahmaputra – National Waterway No. 2 – at Jogighopa.

Marking the occasion, a ship – MV Trishul along with two barges Ajay and Dikshu carrying 110 MT of coal and stone chips to Bangladesh – was flagged off by the Union Minister. The foundation stone for the terminal was laid by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in February 2021.

The Jogighopa terminal is also one of the declared ports-of-call under PIWT&T between India and Bangladesh. By the year 2027, the terminal is expected to handle cargo of 1.1 million tonnes per annum.

Nagaland CM Inaugurated Meluri as Nagaland's 17th District

Nagaland Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio officially inaugurated Meluri as the 17th district of the State. Meluri was earlier a subdivision under the Phek district.

Calling Meluri the 'land of fortunes', he spoke about the district's natural and cultural wealth, including Shiloi Lake, Tizu river, and the Trade Centre at Avakhung.

Semiconductor Unit at Jagiroad to Start Production in 2026

The country's first indigenous semiconductor assembly and test unit at Jagiroad will start production early next year. The facility will produce 15 billion chips every year.

Around 500 women from Assam are being trained in various Tata Electronics facilities and they are working on complex machines used for packaging chips and learning about the ecosystem. For human resource, Tata is working with the Indian institute of Technology Guwahati (IITG) and the National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT) to develop diploma and certification programmes and industry-specific training and curriculum.

Tata City in Assam

As a mark of recognition to the tremendous role and contribution of Late Ratan Tata and the Tata Group towards the State's development, Assam Cabinet has decided to name the upcoming electronic city in Jagiroad as Ratan Tata Electronic City.

Assam Panchayat (Amendment) Bill Passed

The Assam Legislative Assembly Panchayat (Amendent) Bill, 2025. Panchayat Rural Development Minister Ranjeet Kumar Dass moved the Bill in the House. Replying to the discussion on the Bill, Minister Dass informed the House that the Bill seeks to reform the Panchayat system.

Arunachal's Mechuka Won 'Best Mountain Destination' Award

Arunachal Pradesh has bagged the Best Mountain Destination award for Mechuka at the India Today Tourism Awards 2025, held in New Delhi. Organised annually by the India Today media group, the event recognises outstanding achievements in the tourism sector across the country.

GI Tag for Assamese Jewellery

The famed *Axomiya Gohona* (Assamese jewellery) has got the prestigious GI tag. It was registered in March-2025. The application for the registration was filed by Gems and Jewellery Promotion Council of Assam (GJPCA) in March-April, 2022.

Assamese jewellery, commonly known as Axomiya Gohona in the State, is a collection of

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